Drewry

AIS Analytics

Fleet Performance Indicators | Crude Tanker | VLCC

Week 43 2026



Published on: 27 Oct, 2026

Vessel deployment | Speed | Vessel availbility | Fleet performance | Congestion, laden vessels | Congestion, ballast vessels | Glossary

93.7%

Current Utilisation

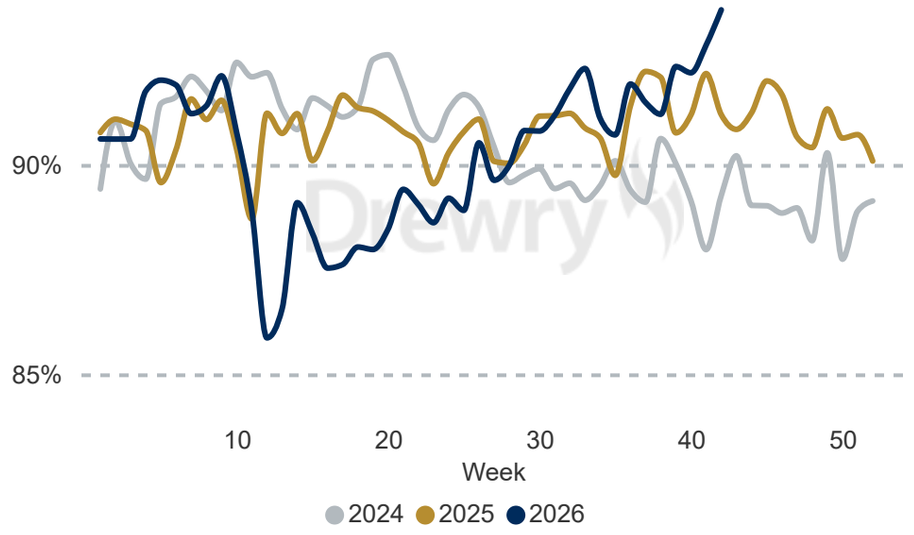
▲ 2.5

MoM percentage point change in utilisation

▲ 2.5

YoY percentage point change in utilisation

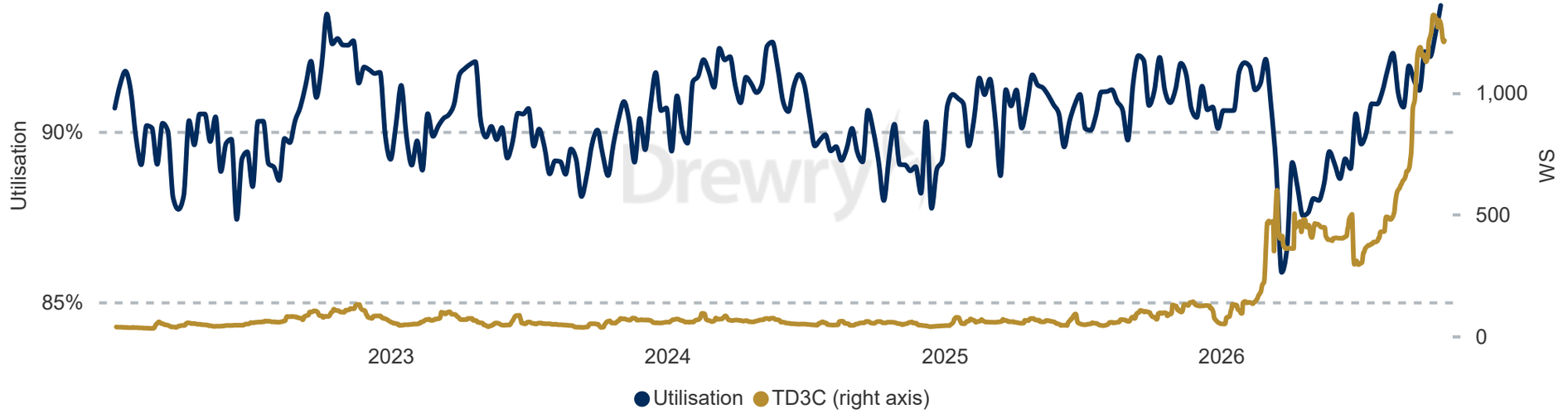
Utilisation



VLCC utilisation strengthens despite weaker tonne-mile demand

- VLCC utilisation rose to 93.7% in Week 43, up 2.5 percentage points MoM and YoY, indicating significantly tighter fleet employment. However, the tonne-mile index remained subdued at 91.7, down 17.4% YoY, suggesting that shorter-haul crude movements and weaker long-haul trade flows continue to weigh on underlying transport demand despite the recent recovery from mid-year lows.
- Higher fleet employment was driven by stronger vessel deployment, with the share of laden vessels declining by 1.6 percentage points MoM in the East and 3.3 percentage points in the West, while the proportion of vessels underway increased and in-port tonnage fell sharply. At the same time, anchored capacity declined by 46.0% MoM in the West and 1.5% in the East, indicating improved vessel circulation and reduced congestion across key trading regions.
- Market tightness remained broadly balanced as stronger utilisation was partially offset by improving fleet productivity. Ballast speeds increased by 6.2% MoM in the East and 8.1% in the West despite bunker prices rising 8.6% MoM to $933/tonne, while laden anchor days increased 3.2% on a four-week moving-average basis.

Utilisation vs Baltic rates



▼ 46.0%

MoM change in vessels' capacity at anchor in West

▼ 1.5%

MoM change in vessels' capacity at anchor in East

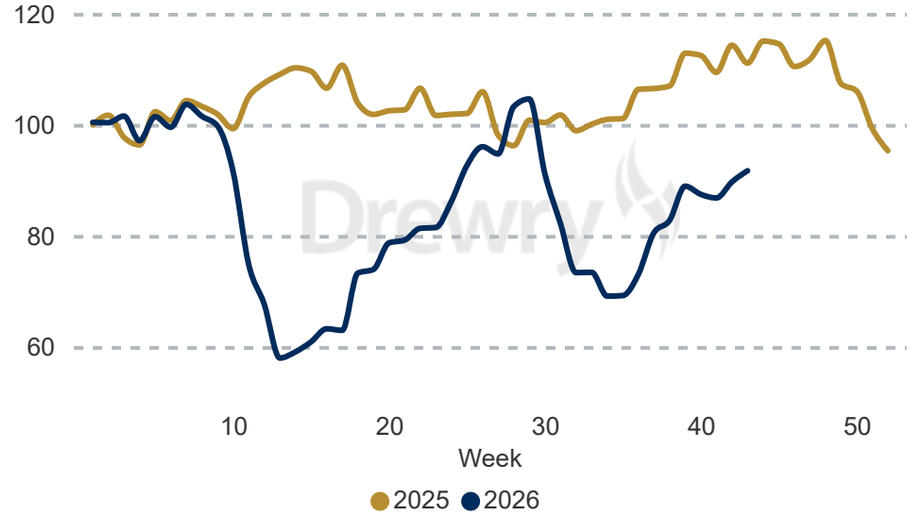
91.7

Current tonne-miles index

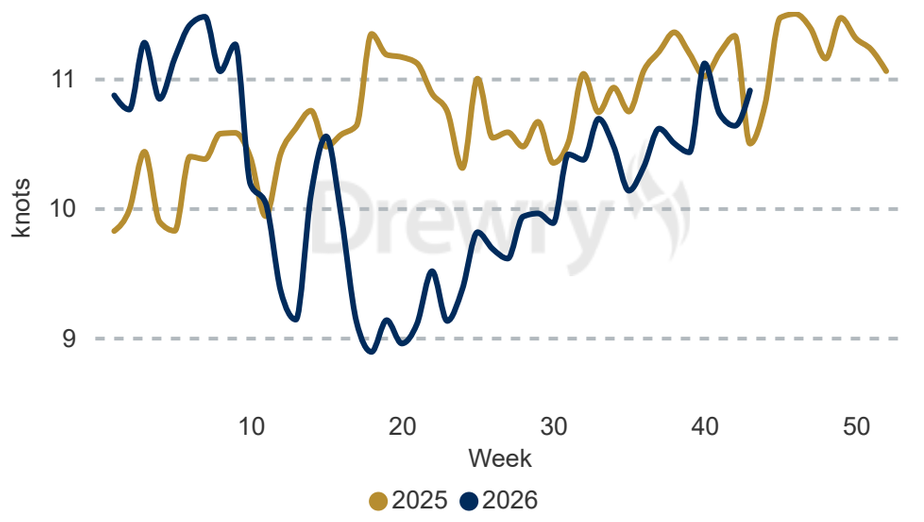
▼ 17.4%

YoY change in tonne-miles index

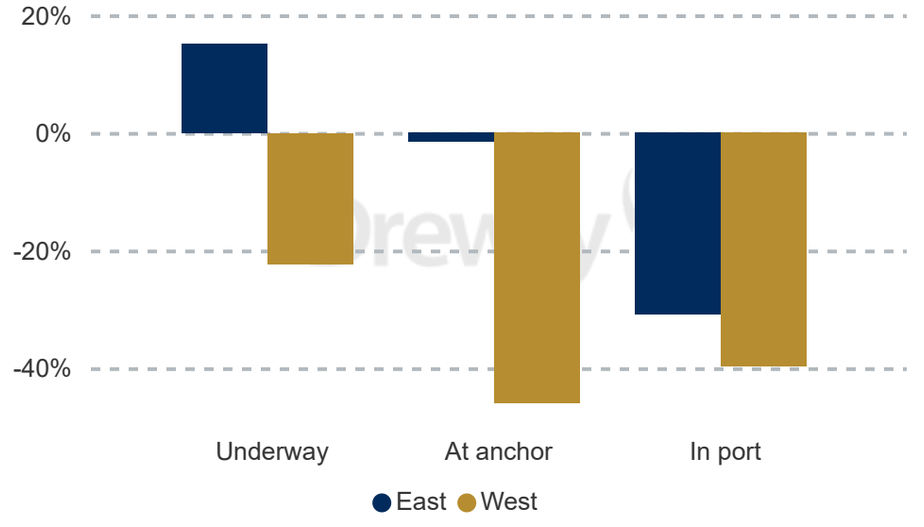
Tonne-miles index (base: week 1, 2025 =100)



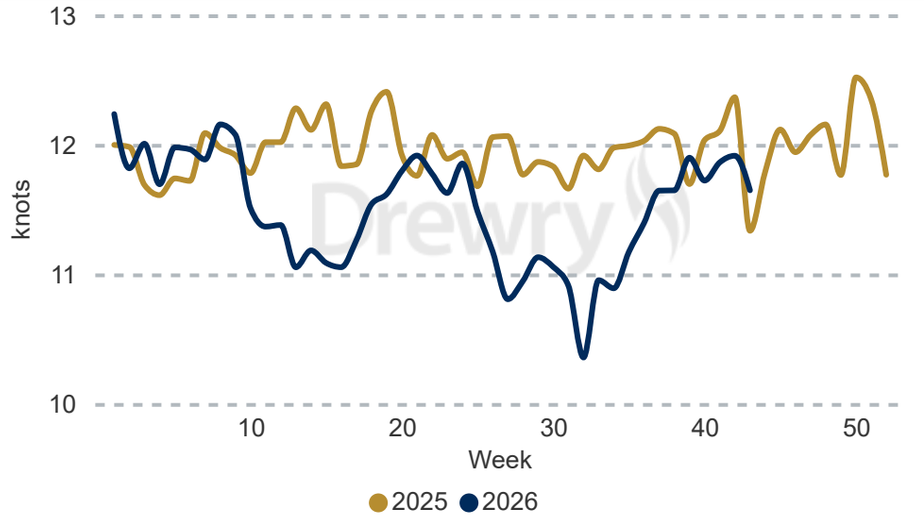
Global ballast speed



Change in trading status - MoM



Global laden speed



$933

per tonne price of bunker at the end of the week

▲ 8.6%

MoM change in bunker price

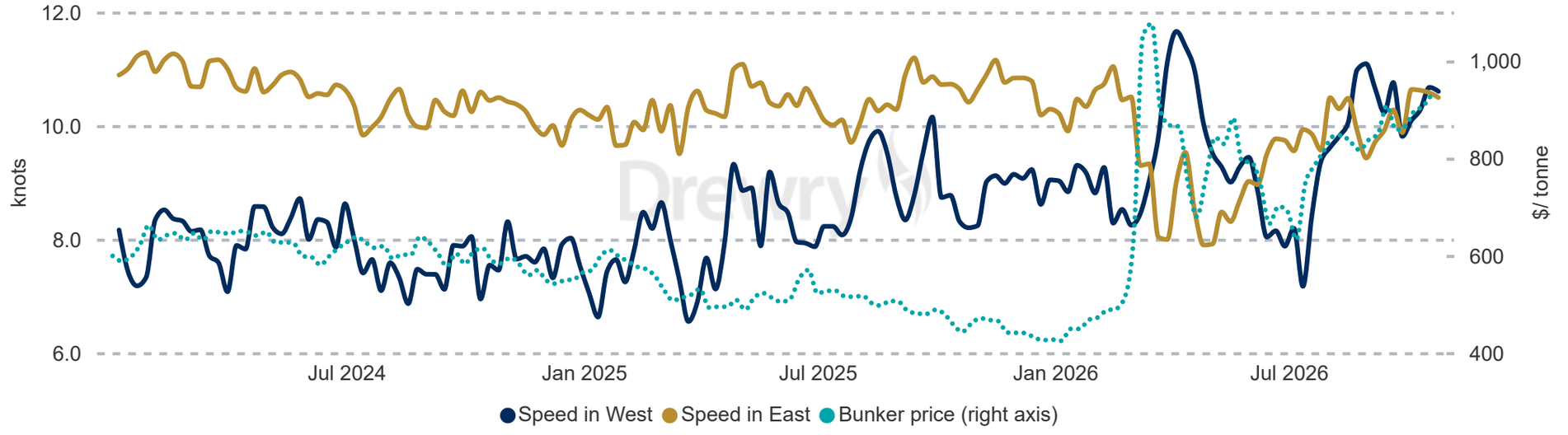
▲ 6.2%

MoM change in ballast speed in East

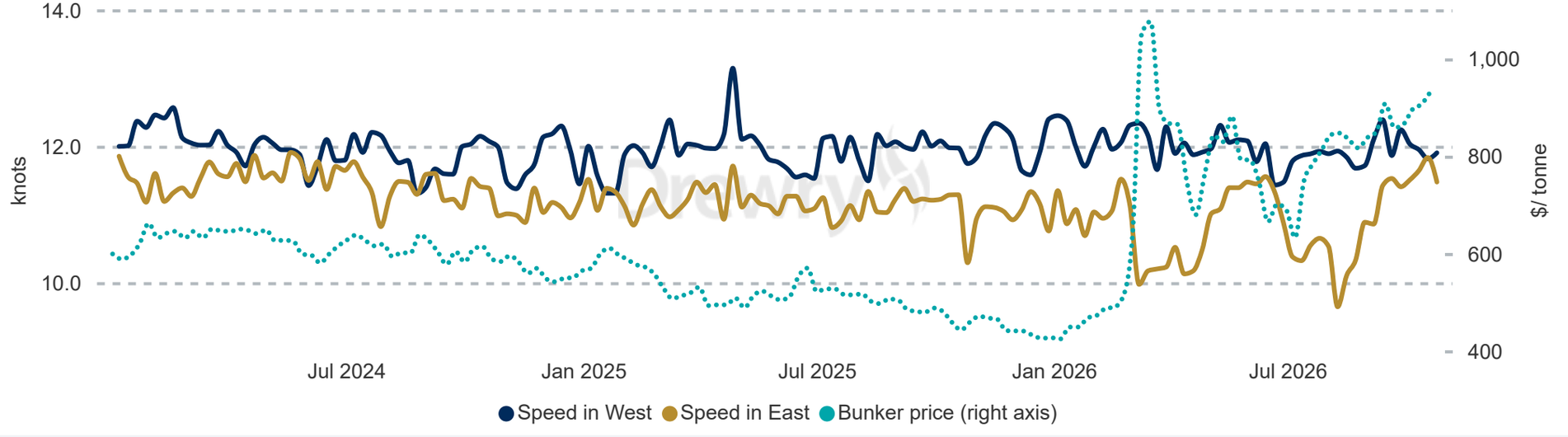
▲ 8.1%

MoM change in ballast speed in West

Ballast speed vs bunker price



Laden speed vs bunker price



▼ 2.9

mdwt change in tonnage at anchor (4-week moving average)

▲ 3.2%

change in laden anchor days (4-week moving average)

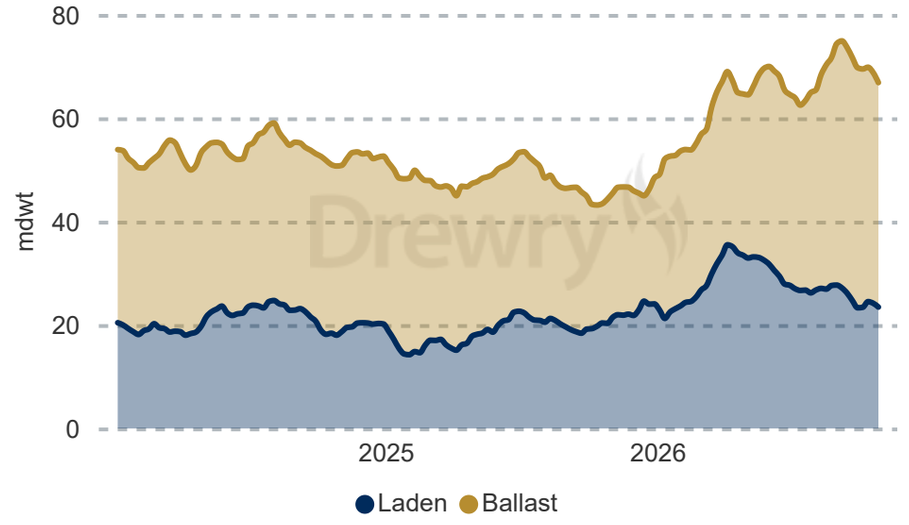
▼ 1.6

MoM percentage point change in the share of laden vessels in East

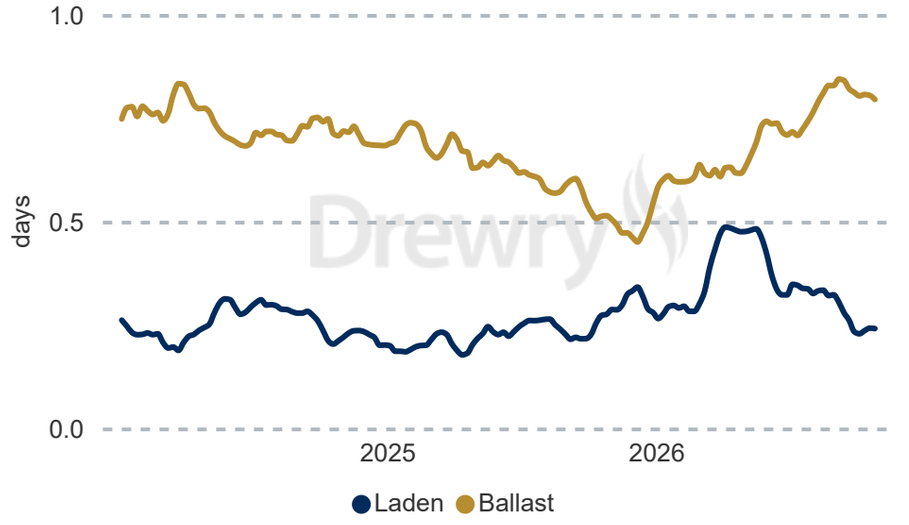
▼ 3.3

MoM percentage point change in the share of laden vessels in West

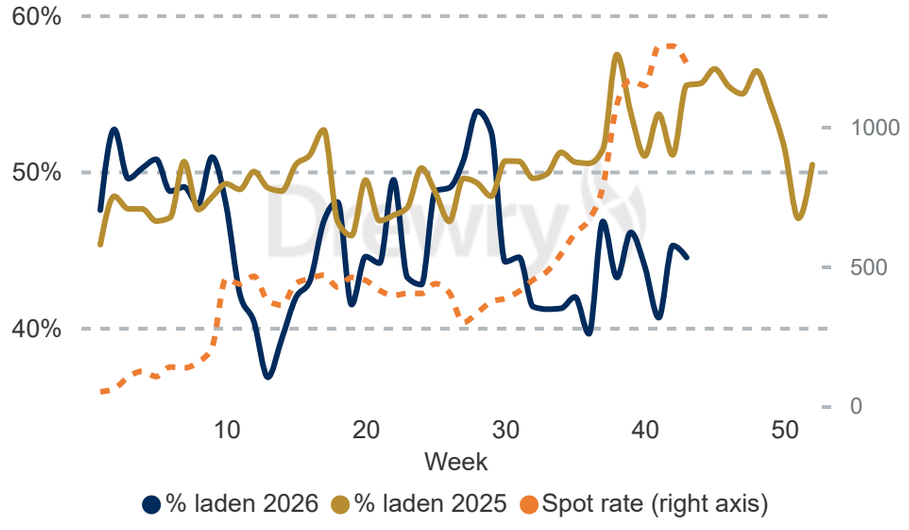
Tonnage at anchor, global- 4 week moving average



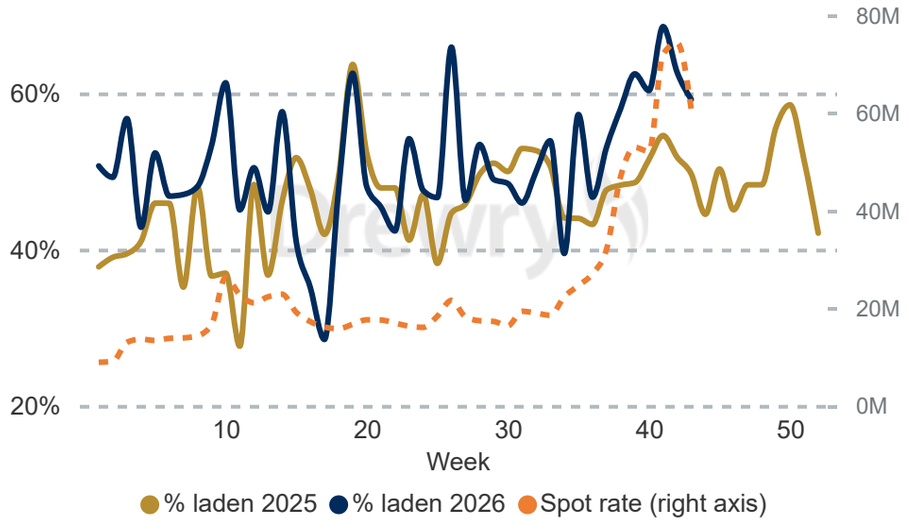
Days at anchor, global- 4 week moving average



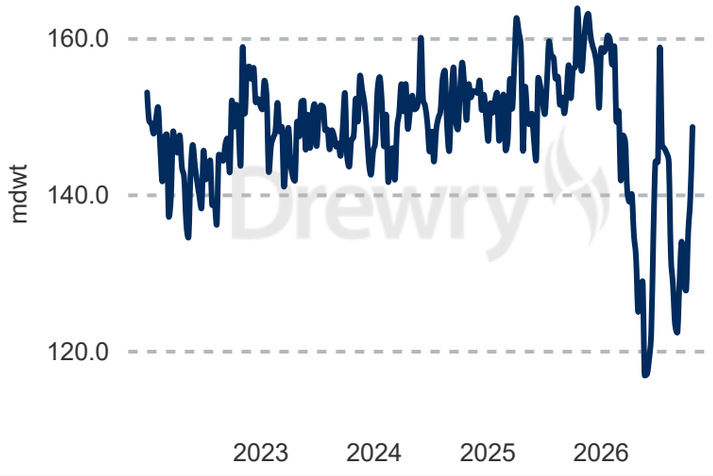
East (% laden) vsTD3C (WS)



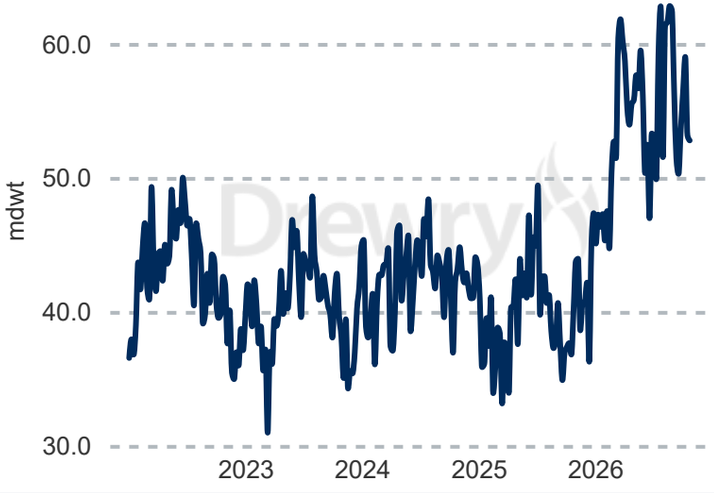
West (% laden) vsTD22 ($m)



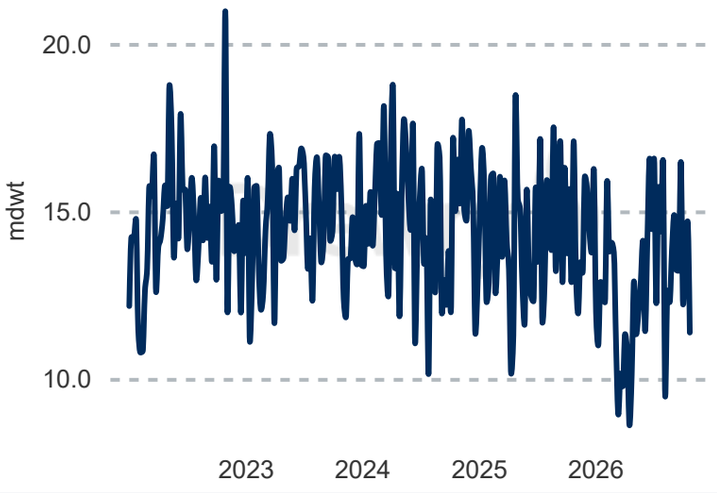
Tonnage underway, East



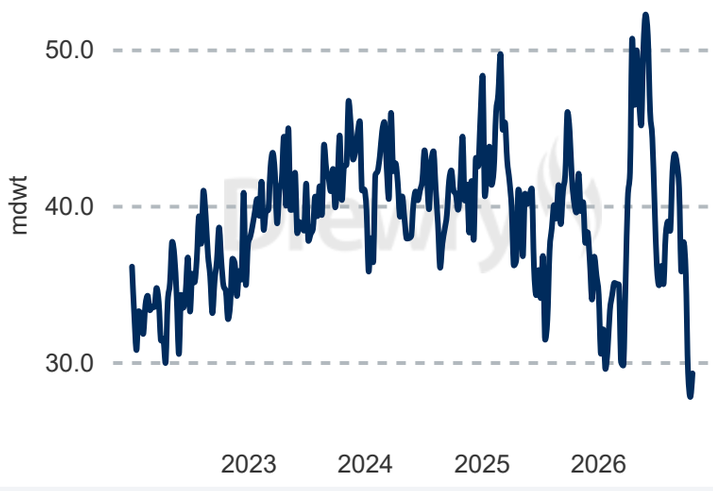
Tonnage at anchor, East



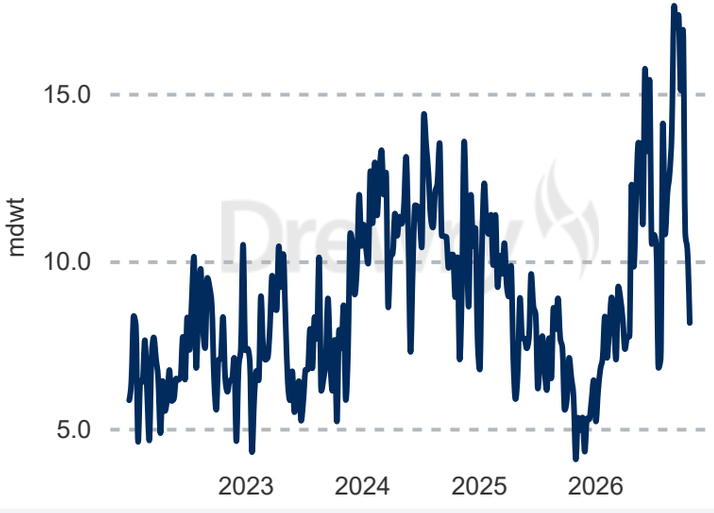
Tonnage in port, East



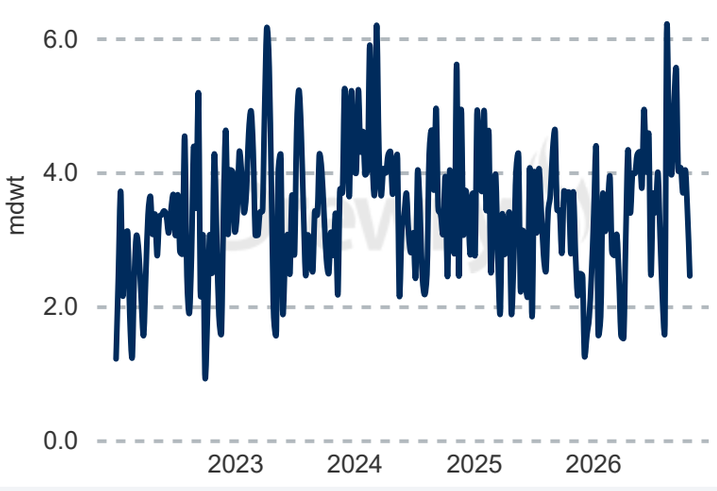
Tonnage underway, West



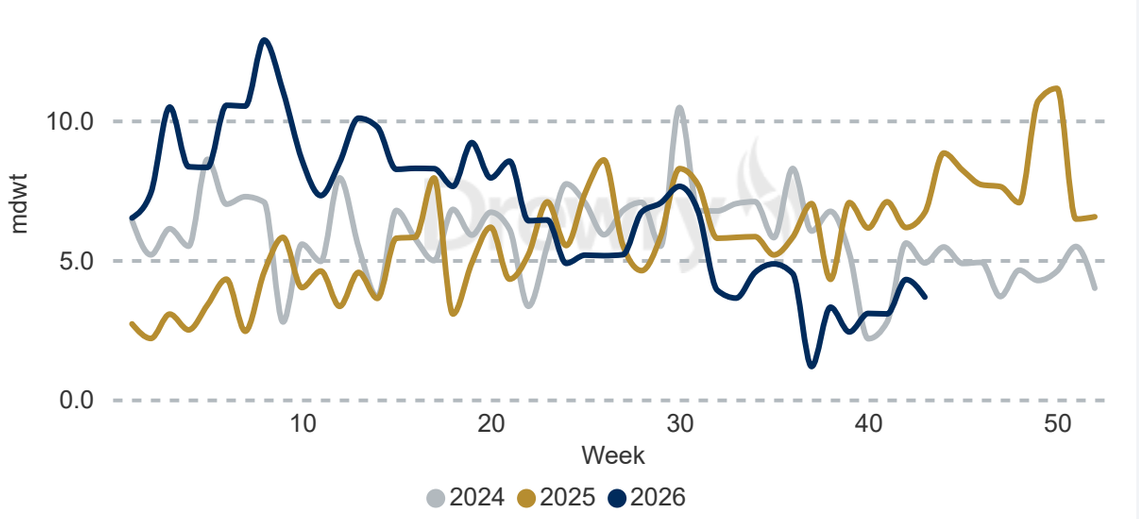
Tonnage at anchor, West



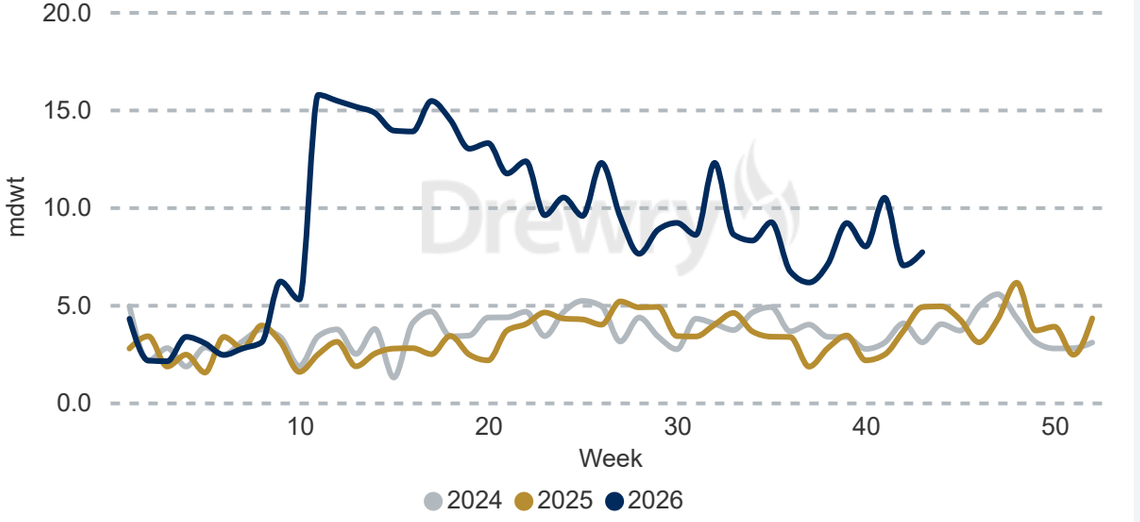
Tonnage in port, West



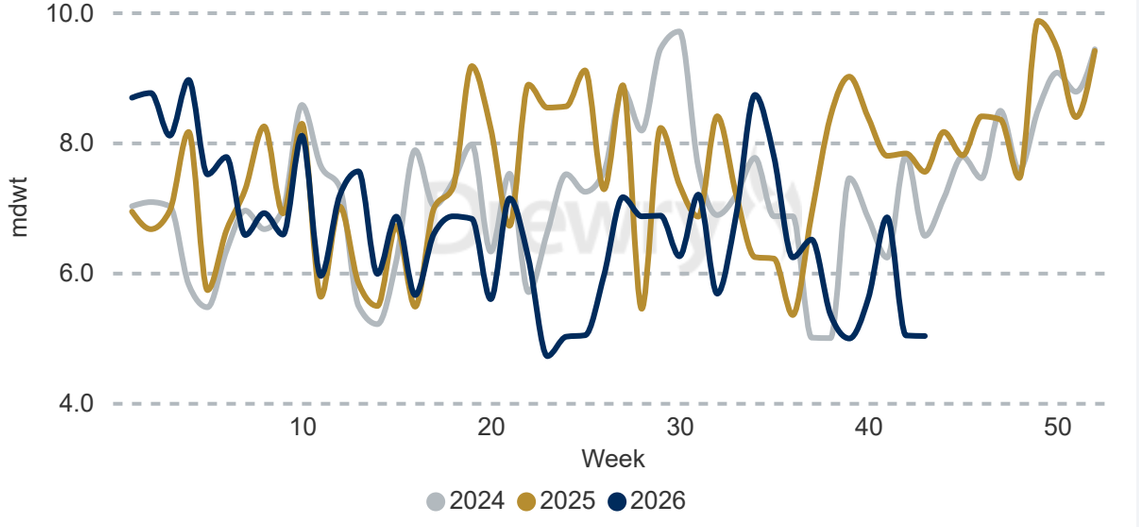
Laden tonnage at anchor in China



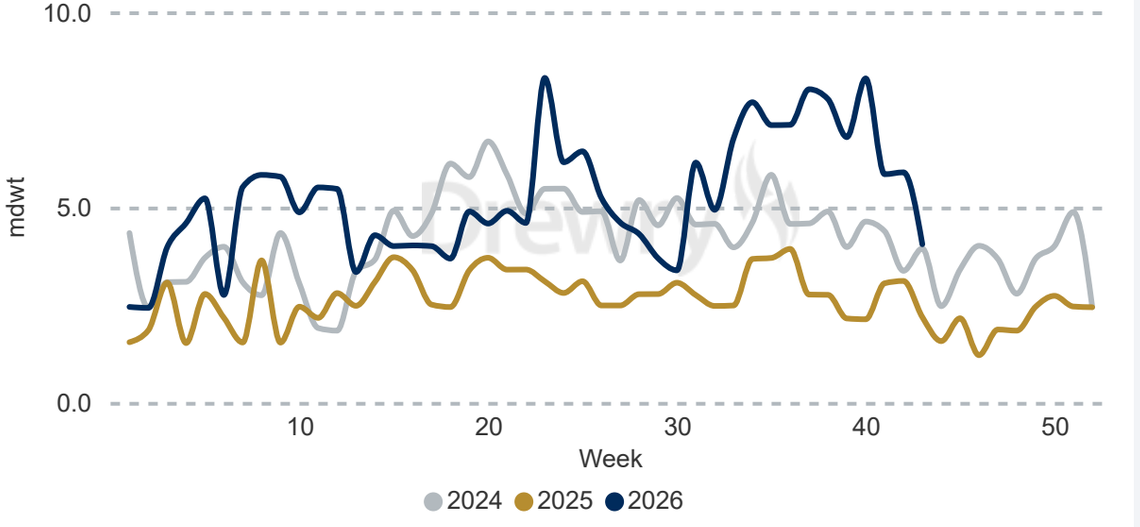
Laden tonnage at anchor in Indian



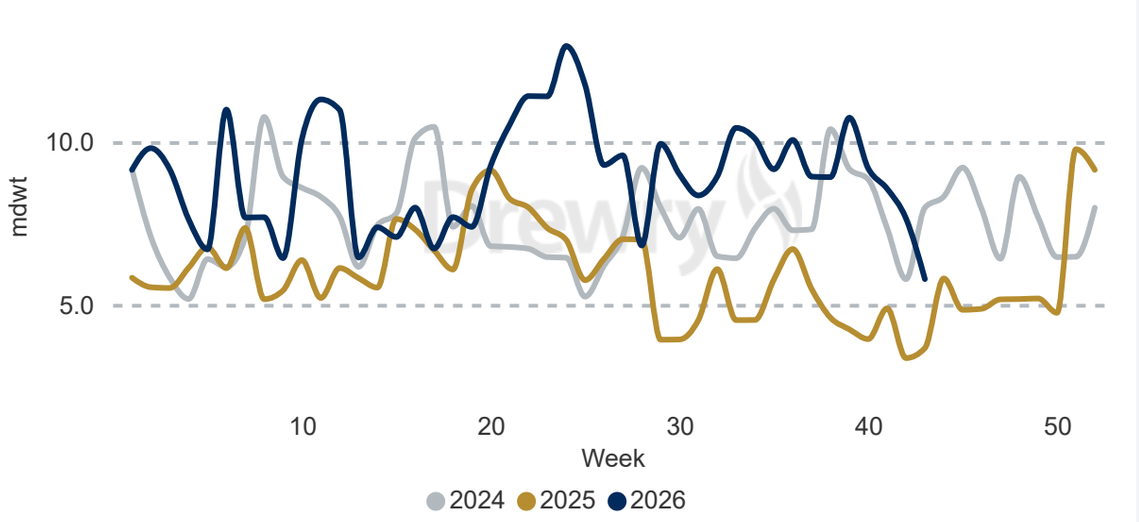
Laden tonnage at anchor in Pacific



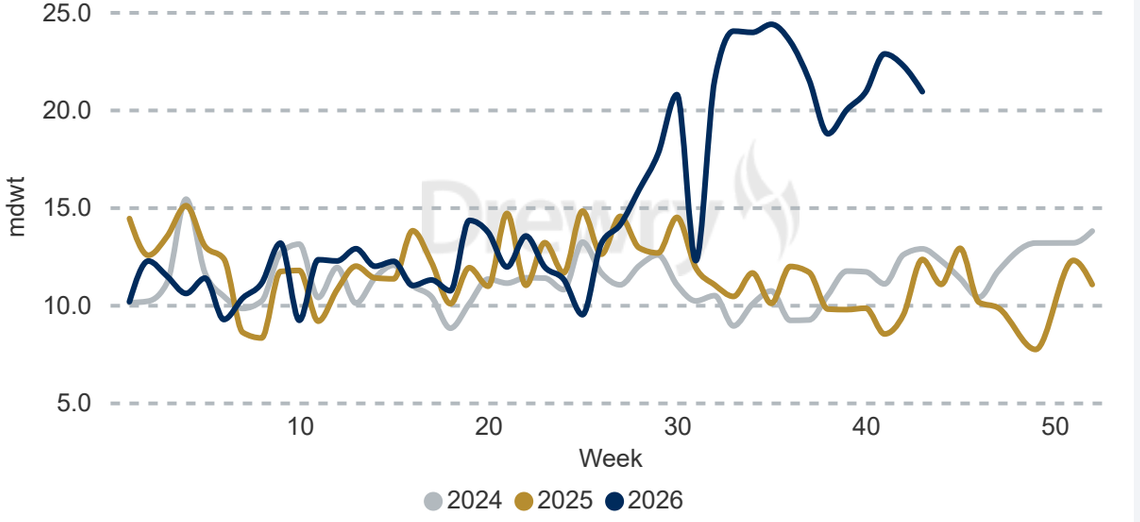
Laden tonnage at anchor in Atlantic



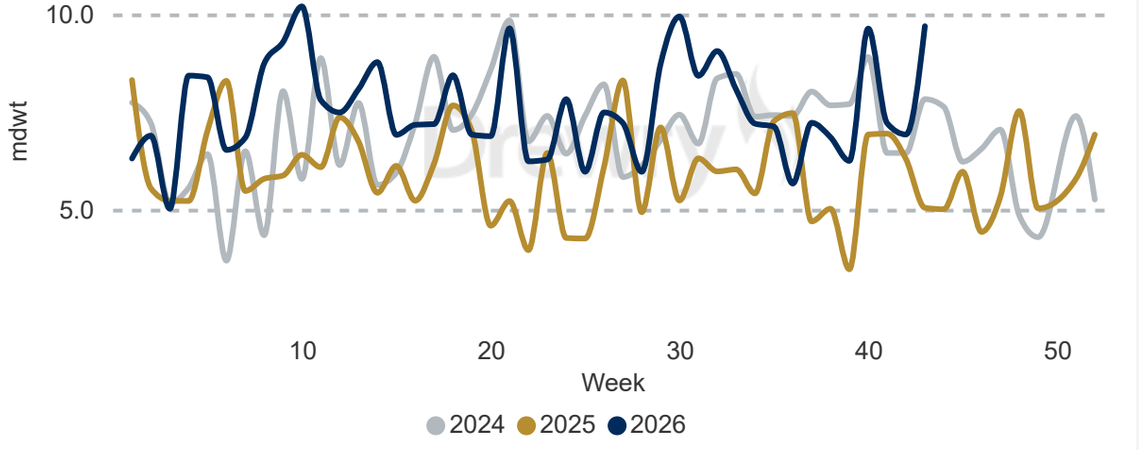
Ballast tonnage at anchor in China



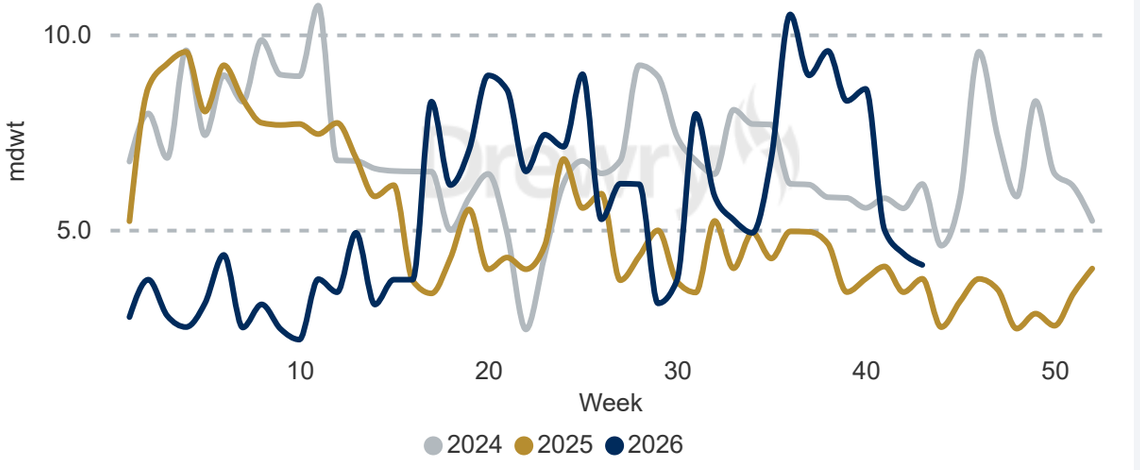
Ballast tonnage at anchor in Indian



Ballast tonnage at anchor in Pacific



Ballast tonnage at anchor in Atlantic



S No.	Terms	Define
1	VLCC vessel	All Crude tankers which are above 200,000 dwt.
2	Trading status	Status of vessels has been derived primarily from the navigation field within the AIS message. Vessels which do not have IMO number have not been included in the fleet. Furthermore, vessels that have not returned AIS message for at least 30 days, have been excluded from the analysis of fleet status while vessels that have not returned an AIS message for up to 30 days are assumed to have the same trading status as when last seen.
3	Laden dwt miles	Average distance travelled per week across the laden target fleet multiplied by the average vessel deadweight(or capacity) for that fleet
4	Bunker price	Price of the VLSFO at Singapore Port
5	% Laden	Share of laden vessels in total fleet excluding vessels under repair
6	East	East of Suez Canal and comprises China, Pacific, Indian Ocean and Oceania
7	West	West of Suez Canal and comprises Atlantic region
8	TD3C	Spot rates on the ME Gulf-China route; the data has been taken from the Baltic Exchange.
9	TD22	Spot rates on the US Gulf-China route; the data has been taken from the Baltic Exchange.
10	At anchor	Vessels with navigation status ‘At Anchor’ in the waiting zone near port area
11	Moored	Vessels moored in port for loading or discharging
12	Underway	Vessels currently at sea and are currently underway towards their destination